

PHISHING EMAIL TEMPLATE



Course : CSDF

College: Shree LR Tiwari College Of Engineering

Report By: Mubasshera Zaidy

PHISHING

Phishing is a type of cyberattack where attackers impersonate trusted sources — like banks, companies, or government agencies — to trick people into giving up sensitive information. This often happens through fake emails, messages, or websites that look real but are designed to steal things like passwords, credit card numbers, or login credentials.

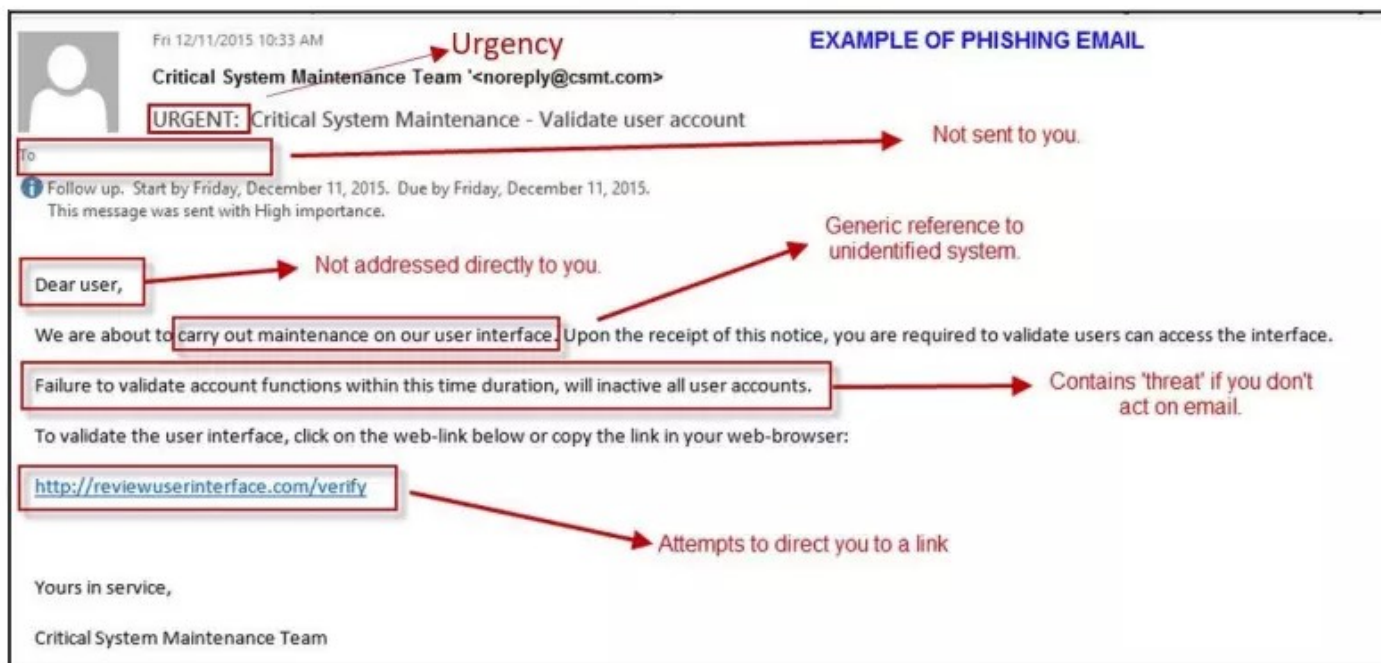
Instead of breaking into systems directly, phishing relies on social engineering — manipulating human emotions like fear, urgency, or curiosity.

A phishing email attack : The goal is to steal personal or financial information. To understand which data in your organisation is at risk, you must first understand why hackers want it. Attackers attempt to obtain information that will allow them to profit in some way. They can profit from your data in three ways :

1. Personal Gain: Using stolen info to access money or assets with minimal risk to themselves.
2. Selling Data: Trading stolen data (e.g., credit card numbers) on the dark web.
3. Third-Party Espionage: Stealing data for governments or companies in exchange for payment.

ANALYSING A PHISHING EMAIL TEMPLATE

EXAMPLE OF PHISHING EMAIL



- This email is a textbook example of social engineering. It's designed to manipulate the recipient into clicking a malicious link by exploiting urgency, fear, and authority. Let's walk through each element and unpack the tactics behind it.

1. Subject Line and Tone: "URGENT" / "Critical System Maintenance"

The attacker uses emotionally charged language to trigger panic. Words like "URGENT" are meant to short-circuit rational thinking and push the user into immediate action. "Critical System Maintenance" sounds official and technical, adding a false sense of legitimacy.

2. Generic Greeting: "Dear user"

This is a major red flag. Legitimate organizations almost always address users by name. A generic greeting suggests the email was sent in bulk, likely part of a phishing campaign targeting many recipients.

3. Threatening Language: “Your account will be disabled if you do not act”. This is classic fear-based manipulation. By threatening account deactivation, the attacker pressures the user to act quickly without verifying the legitimacy of the message. It’s a psychological trick to override caution.

4. Suspicious Link: <http://reviewuserinterface.cdm.com/verify>

The link looks technical and official at first glance, but it’s deceptive. The domain cdm.com may not be affiliated with any known organization, and the subdomain `reviewuserinterface` is designed to sound like an internal system. The use of HTTP instead of HTTPS is another red flag—secure sites use HTTPS to encrypt traffic.

5. Sender Address: `noreply@csmt.com`

This email address is crafted to look official, but it’s likely spoofed or from a lookalike domain. “csmt.com” doesn’t clearly map to any known service, and attackers often use similar-looking domains to trick users into trusting the message.

6. Lack of Branding or Signature:

There’s no company logo, no contact information, and no real signature. Legitimate emails from IT departments or service providers usually include branding, a professional footer, and contact details. The absence of these elements suggests the email is not from a trusted source.

Conclusion & Prevention:

This phishing email relies on urgency, fear, and impersonation to trick users into clicking a malicious link. To prevent falling victim, always verify the sender, avoid clicking suspicious URLs, and report anything unusual to your IT or security team. Awareness is your first line of defense—recognizing these tactics is key to staying secure in today’s threat landscape.